

Application for Cybersecurity Graduate Programme

Dear National Highways Recruitment Team,

I am applying for the Cybersecurity Graduate Programme at National Highways because it combines the analytical and technical work I already do with the critical infrastructure protection I want to build. The opportunity to safeguard the digital and operational technology that supports the UK's road network while gaining hands-on experience across a large and complex organisation is exactly the environment I need to grow. I am available to start in September 2027 and comfortable with the Manchester location and hybrid working arrangement.

My background combines practical IT support and security work with formal analytical training. I am an MSc Information Security graduate from Royal Holloway, awarded with Merit, with CompTIA Security+ and ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity, preceded by a BCA in computer applications. That means I understand not only how to resolve technical problems but how to approach complex challenges in a structured way, which is central to a role that requires critical thinking, problem solving and a positive mindset.

In my current IT support position I am the first point of contact for 15 colleagues across 15 to 20 devices, troubleshooting access and system problems, monitoring server health and maintaining network and website-access controls. I handle four to five access requests a day through on-premises Active Directory and investigate four to five suspicious emails a day, recording findings and alerting colleagues to recurring tactics. I also built a local tool that maps Windows error codes to their common causes and used it to trace intermittent server freezes to missing or corrupted DLLs. My technical skills include Python, PowerShell and SQL, which I use for task automation and data analysis.

Two things I want to be straightforward about. I have not worked in critical infrastructure or transport, so that domain knowledge is something I would expect to develop through National Highways' graduate programme rather than claim as existing experience. What I do bring is a genuine analytical mindset and attention to detail. At Co-op, as Person in Charge, I conduct weekly risk assessments and daily compliance checks, maintain the assessment records, and coordinate seven or eight colleagues per shift while explaining requirements to people who have no particular interest in them.

What draws me to National Highways specifically is the focus on protecting the digital and operational technology that keeps the country moving. The opportunity to contribute to that work through a structured three-year graduate programme with real responsibility, dedicated mentorship and a clear pathway to a permanent cybersecurity role is exactly the kind of challenge I am looking for. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experience could contribute to your team.

Kind regards,

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